

Equitable Holdings, Inc.

Recommendation **BUY** ★ ★ ★ ★ ★

Price
USD 26.16 [as of market close Oct 27, 2023] **12-Mo. Target Price** USD 33.00

Report Currency
USD

Investment Style
Mid-Cap Value

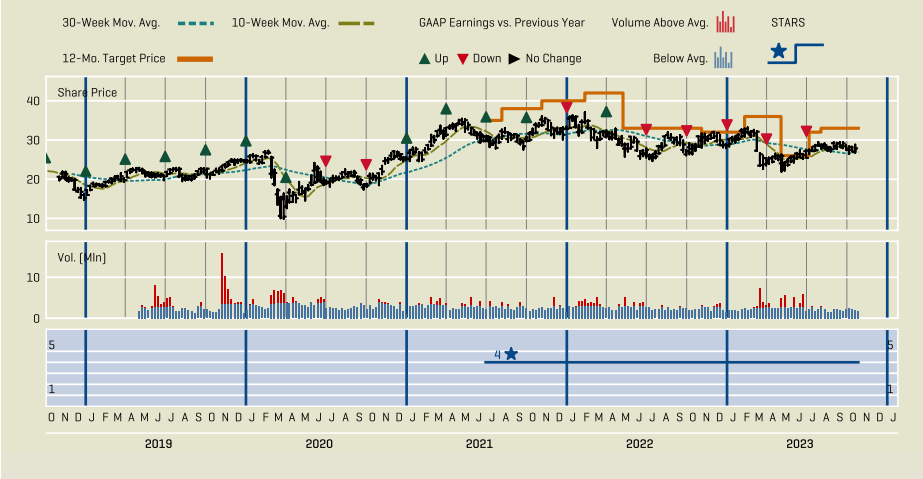
Equity Analyst Catherine Seifert

GICS Sector Financials
Sub-Industry Diversified Financial Services

Summary This leading financial services firm offers insurance, retirement, and asset management products through wholly-owned Equitable and 65%-owned AllianceBernstein.

Key Stock Statistics (Source: CFRA, S&P Global Market Intelligence (SPGMI), Company Reports)									
52-Wk Range	USD 33.24 - 21.89	Oper.EPS2023E	USD 4.95	Market Capitalization[B]	USD 9.09	Beta			1.38
Trailing 12-Month EPS	USD 4.52	Oper.EPS2024E	USD 6.40	Yield [%]	3.36	3-yr Proj. EPS CAGR[%]			12
Trailing 12-Month P/E	5.79	P/E on Oper.EPS2023E	5.28	Dividend Rate/Share	USD 0.88	SPGMI's Quality Ranking			NR
USD 10K Invested 5 Yrs Ago	15,068.0	Common Shares Outstg.[M]	350.00	Trailing 12-Month Dividend	USD 0.84	Institutional Ownership [%]			99.0

Price Performance



Source: CFRA, S&P Global Market Intelligence
Past performance is not an indication of future performance and should not be relied upon as such.
Analysis prepared by **Catherine Seifert** on Aug 09, 2023 03:00 AM ET, when the stock traded at **USD 29.09**.

Highlights

- Following a 9.3% decline in operating revenues in 2022 (versus our forecast of a 2% to 4% drop), we expect revenues to rise by 6% to 9% in 2023 and by 7% to 10% in 2024, reflecting our expectation of a modest recovery in asset values and wider spreads on the rise in interest rates. Our forecast excludes investment and derivative gains and/or losses, which can be significant. Operating revenue weakness in 2022 primarily reflected 11% lower fee revenues, a 14% drop in investment income, and a 9% decline in investment management fees, partly offset by 3.5% higher premiums.
- We expect revenues at 65%-owned AllianceBernstein (AB 30 ****) will be flat to up 6% in 2023 and will rise by 4% to 7% in 2024, versus the 8% drop reported in 2022. AB's assets under management (AUM) of \$691.5 billion at June 30, 2023 rose 7% from \$646.4 billion at December 31, 2022. AB's fund flow trends turned positive in Q1, with inflows of \$800 million, but eroded in Q2 with \$4B of outflows. During 2022, net outflows of \$3.6 billion contrasted with net inflows of \$26.1 billion in 2021.
- We forecast operating EPS of \$4.95 in 2023, rising to \$6.40 in 2024, and to \$7.05 in 2025, versus operating EPS of \$5.08 reported in 2022.

Investment Rationale/Risk

- Our recommendation on the shares is Buy. We expect improved organic growth trends in asset management to offset mixed (but improving) annuity sales trends, coupled with margin improvement, and provide the shares with a catalyst for multiple expansion.
- Risks to our opinion and target price include a sharp drop in equity markets, a significant economic downturn, and a greater-than-anticipated level of equity market and interest rate volatility.
- Our 12-month target price of \$33 assumes the shares trade at 6.7x our 2023 operating EPS estimate of \$4.95 and at 5.2x our 2024 operating EPS estimate of \$6.40, versus its one-year average forward multiple of 5x. Our target multiple assumes steps EQH has taken to reduce its risk profile (including reinsuring a large block of legacy annuities with steep benefit guarantees), coupled with an expected uptick in demand for retirement savings products, and the recovery in asset values and fund flow trends at AB will provide the shares with a catalyst for multiple expansion. Our target multiple assumes the shares trade at a discount to the peer average of 7.8x, reflecting their concentrated exposure to variable annuities and other long tail risks.

Analyst's Risk Assessment

LOW **MEDIUM** **HIGH**

Our risk assessment reflects our view of the company's concentration in the annuity space, partly offset by a degree of diversification it derives from its life insurance unit and its asset management operations (conducted through 65%-owned AllianceBernstein Holding L.P.). We also acknowledge steps EQH has taken to reduce its exposure to costly annuity guaranteed benefits, like reinsuring a legacy book of business.

Revenue/Earnings Data

Revenue (Million USD)					
	1Q	2Q	3Q	4Q	Year
2023	2,357	2,377	--	--	--
2022	3,146	4,690	3,134	1,960	14,509
2021	2,424	4,121	3,548	3,260	13,353
2020	8,951	-2,543	1,899	1,276	9,583
2019	118	1,904	3,078	2,482	7,586
2018	3,581	3,464	1,083	4,597	12,069

Earnings Per Share (USD)

	1Q	2Q	3Q	4Q	Year
2025	E 1.68	E 1.65	E 1.85	E 1.87	E 7.05
2024	E 1.53	E 1.50	E 1.67	E 1.70	E 6.40
2023	0.96	1.17	E 1.40	E 1.42	E 4.95
2022	1.36	1.31	1.28	1.11	5.08
2021	1.35	1.71	1.94	1.54	6.58
2020	1.08	1.00	1.24	1.65	4.99

Fiscal Year ended Dec 31. EPS Estimates based on CFRA's Operating Earnings; historical earnings are adjusted. In periods where a different currency has been reported, this has been adjusted to match the current quoted currency.

Dividend Data

Amount [USD]	Date Decl.	Ex-Div. Date	Stk. of Record	Payment Date
0.2200	Jul 28	Aug 04	Aug 07	Aug 14 '23
0.2200	May 24	Jun 02	Jun 05	Jun 12 '23
0.2000	Feb 15	Feb 24	Feb 27	Mar 06 '23
0.2000	Nov 17	Nov 25	Nov 28	Dec 05 '22

Dividends have been paid since 2018 . Source: Company reports
Past performance is not an indication of future performance and should not be relied as such.
Forecasts are not a reliable indicator of future performance. Dividends paid in currencies other than the Trading currency have been accordingly converted for display purposes.

Equitable Holdings, Inc.

Business Summary Aug 09, 2023

CORPORATE OVERVIEW. Equitable Holdings, Inc. (EQH) is a leading financial services firm offering insurance, retirement, and asset management products through wholly-owned Equitable and AllianceBernstein (AB 30 ***), in which EQH has a 65% economic interest. Prior to its IPO in May 2018, EQH was a wholly-owned subsidiary of AXA. EQH conducts its operations through four segments: Individual Retirement (which accounted for 50% of segment operating profits in 2022), Group Retirement (23%), Investment Management and Research (19%), and Protection Solutions (8%). Operating revenues of \$13.3 billion in 2022 (down from operating revenue of \$14.6 billion in 2021) were divided: investment management fees 37%, insurance and annuity fees 24%, net investment income 25%, premiums 7%, and other revenues 7%.

The Individual Retirement segment is a leading provider of variable annuity products aimed at high-net-worth retirement savers. EQH offers three primary annuity products: Its Structured Capital Strategies annuity is an index-linked variable annuity product without guaranteed benefit features. The Retirement Cornerstone annuity product is offered in two versions, one with a broad selection of investment options but without guaranteed benefits and one with a focused selection of investment options and an optional floating rate guaranteed benefit feature. Investment Edge is a wealth accumulation annuity designed to defer current taxes during the accumulation phase and provide tax-efficient distributions with a portion of each payment structured as a return of cost basis, and excluded from taxes.

The Group Retirement segment offers tax-deferred investment and retirement products (primarily variable annuities and mutual funds) and services to educational entities, municipalities, non-profit entities, and small to mid-sized businesses. We estimate Tax-exempt clients account for about 70% of gross premiums (which include first year and renewal premiums) while corporate and other clients for the remaining 30% of gross premiums.

The Investment Management and Research unit represents EQH's 65% economic interest in AB, a publicly traded master limited partnership. AB provides investment management and research services to a broad range of institutional and high-net-worth clients globally. At June 30, 2023, AB had \$691.5 billion of assets under management (AUM), comprising 43% of equities, 39% fixed income, and 18% multi-asset class, alternatives, and other assets.

Protection Solutions consists of EQH's life insurance and employee benefits businesses. EQH focuses on the less capital-intensive areas of the life insurance space, with an emphasis on universal and term life insurance. EQH entered the employee benefits market in 2015 and is focused on the small- to medium-sized market, offering a suite of products, including life insurance, long- and short-term disability protections, and dental and vision products. EQH expanded its product offerings in 2020 with the introduction of a critical illness and accident product.

EQH has a multi-channel distribution platform that includes its proprietary sales force of over 4,500 Equitable Advisors serving the retail market, while AB's 200-plus advisors serve the high net worth and institutional market. The company also has a number of third-party distribution agreements in place that give it access to more than 150,000 financial professionals. AB also has more than 5,00 retail distribution partners.

CORPORATE STRATEGY. Given the challenges of low interest rates and volatile equity markets pressuring all financial services companies, we expect EQH will focus on de-risking its balance sheet, supporting margins, and making targeted, strategic investments in its businesses. EQH's individual annuity strategy has evolved over the last decade or so in response to the decline in interest rates.

As a result, the majority of new annuity sales in recent years were of products without guaranteed benefit features.

IMPORTANT DEVELOPMENTS. EQH executed a significant component of its long-term risk management strategy on June 1, 2021, when it completed the reinsurance of legacy variable annuity policies sold between 2006 and 2008 and backed by about \$12 billion in assets, with Venerable Holdings, Inc. in a transaction set to generate some \$1.2 billion of value for EQH, including an \$800 million capital release.

FINANCIAL TRENDS. During 2020, as part of its annual actuarial review, EQH incurred an after-tax charge of \$2 billion, reflecting changes to interest rate, credit risk, and policyholder behavior assumptions, as well as assumption changes driven by the extraordinary economic conditions as a result of the Covid-19 pandemic.

EQH's investment portfolio had a value of \$97.4 billion at year-end 2022, of which 67% was in fixed income investments, 3% in equity investments, 1% in trading securities, 17% in mortgages, 4% in policy loans, and 8% in other invested assets. This invested asset mix is about in line with those of other life insurers with similar business and product mixes.

During the five years ended December 31, 2022, EQH has total revenues at a compound annual rate (CAGR) of 2.4%, while operating profits grew at a CAGR of 13.2% during the same period.

Corporate information

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Officers

Senior EVP & COO

J. J. Hurd

Senior EVP & CFO

R. M. Raju

Independent Chair

J. M. Lamm-Tennant

Senior VP, Chief Accounting Officer & Controller

W. J. Eckert

President, CEO & Director

M. Pearson

Senior EVP, Chief Legal Officer & Corporate Secretary

J. R. Gonzalez

Board Members

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F. A. Hondal

B. L. Scott

G. H. Stansfield

C. C. MacKay

J. M. Lamm-Tennant

C. T. Stonehill

M. Pearson

D. G. Kaye

Domicile

Delaware

Auditor

PricewaterhouseCoopers LLP

Founded

1859

Employees

10,300

Stockholders

10



Equitable Holdings, Inc.

Quantitative Evaluations					Expanded Ratio Analysis					
Fair Value Rank		1	2	3	4	5	2022	2021	2020	2019
	LOWEST						HIGHEST			
	Based on CFRA's proprietary quantitative model, stocks are ranked from most overvalued [1] to most undervalued [5].									
Fair Value Calculation	USD 23.18	Analysis of the stock's current worth, based on CFRA's proprietary quantitative model suggests that EQH is overvalued by USD 2.98 or 11.39%				Price/Sales0.751.021.201.61 Price/Tangible Book Value-1.872.551.201.48 Price/Pretax Income4.32NMNMNM P/E Ratio5.654.985.135.11 % LT Debt to Capitalization46.0925.8619.5920.15 Avg. Diluted Shares Outstg. [M]379.90417.40450.40493.60				
Figures based on fiscal year-end price										
Volatility		LOW	AVERAGE		HIGH		Key Growth Rates and Averages			
Technical Evaluation	NEUTRAL	Since October, 2023, the technical indicators for EQH have been NEUTRAL"				Past Growth Rate [%]1 Year3 Years5 Years				
Insider Activity		UNFAVORABLE	NEUTRAL		FAVORABLE		Net IncomeNM0.4016.44			
Ratio Analysis (Annual Avg.)										
							Return on Equity [%]23.276.994.98			
							Return on Assets [%]0.740.130.03			

Company Financials Fiscal year ending Dec 31										
Per Share Data (USD)		2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	2015	2014
Tangible Book Value		-15.37	12.87	21.28	16.69	16.84	15.04	10.66	8.95	N/A
Free Cash Flow		-2.91	-2.29	-0.49	-0.63	-0.11	-0.61	-0.59	-0.49	-1.28
Earnings		4.49	-1.24	-1.56	-3.57	3.33	1.48	2.24	0.58	2.91
Earnings (Normalized)		5.08	6.58	4.99	4.85	3.89	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Dividends		0.80	0.72	0.68	0.58	0.39	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Payout Ratio (%)		20.95	NM	NM	NM	8.46	NM	NM	NM	NM
Prices: High		37.13	36.09	27.30	25.18	23.21	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Prices: Low		24.61	24.56	9.89	15.94	14.72	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
P/E Ratio: High		7.30	5.50	5.50	5.20	6.00	NM	NM	NM	NM
P/E Ratio: Low		4.80	3.70	2.00	3.30	3.80	NM	NM	NM	NM
Income Statement Analysis (Million USD)										
Net Interest Income		N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Revenue		14,509	13,353	9,583	7,586	12,069	12,460	11,763	10,043	13,063
Interest Expense		N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Loan Loss Provision		N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
% Expense/Operating Revenue		77.80	82.10	138.90	151.00	75.70	88.20	81.10	94.40	78.40
Pretax Income		2,525	-169.00	-1,093	-2,060	2,490	1,306	2,027	428.00	2,427
Effective Tax Rate (%)		19.80	85.80	68.10	28.80	12.10	3.80	18.60	-51.90	19.70
Net Income		1,785	NM	NM	NM	1,855	834.00	1,254	325.00	1,630
Net Income (Normalized)		1,337	NM	NM	NM	1,355	393.20	885.00	NM	1,197
Balance Sheet and Other Financial Data (Million USD)										
Total Assets		253,468	292,262	275,397	249,818	220,797	235,615	216,645	205,569	N/A
% Return on Assets		0.74	0.53	-0.89	-1.03	0.80	0.41	0.66	NM	NM
% Return on Equity		23.30	-0.20	-2.10	-9.50	13.40	7.80	11.60	NM	NM
% Return on Common Equity		33.90	-4.30	-5.20	-13.30	13.60	6.70	11.50	N/A	N/A
% Return on Capital		13.80	7.11	-10.83	-11.65	7.94	3.81	5.98	N/A	N/A

Source: S&P Global Market Intelligence. Data may be preliminary or restated; before results of discontinued operations/special items. Per share data adjusted for stock dividends; EPS diluted. E-Estimated. NA-Not Available. NM-Not Meaningful. NR-Not Ranked. UR-Under Review.

Equitable Holdings, Inc.

Sector Outlook

CFRA recommends marketweighting the S&P 500 Financials sector. Year-to-date through October 13, 2023, the S&P 500 Financials index, which represented 12.7% of the S&P 500 index, was down 3.1% in price, compared with the 12.7% gain for the S&P 500. In 2022, this sector index fell 12.4% versus a price decline of 19.4% for the 500. There are 13 sub-industry indices in this sector. Diversified banks is the largest, representing 21.2% of the sector’s market value, while reinsurance is the smallest, accounting for 0.38% of the sector. This sector can be represented by the Financial Select Sector SPDR ETF [XLF 33 ****].

The cap-weighted average of this sector’s component company CFRA STARS (STock Appreciation Ranking System) is 3.6 out of 5.0, as compared with a cap-weighted average of 3.7 for the S&P 500. In addition, the sector has an above-average percentage of component issues with favorable investment recommendations. The sub-industries within this sector that currently show the highest average STARS are asset management, consumer finance, investment banking & brokerage, multi-line insurance, reinsurance, and transaction processing & payment services. Those with the lowest average STARS include diversified banks, insurance brokers, life & health insurance, and multi-sector holdings.

Tailwinds for the group include 1) financials posting the highest average price increase in the period between the last rate hike/first rate cut since 1988; 2) CFRA projecting a soft landing, not a recession; 3) us seeing the Federal Reserve starting a rate-cutting cycle around mid-2024; 4) consumers and households remaining resilient to pricing pressures (fuel, shelter, food, and other costs); 5) project credit delinquencies, credit loan losses, and net charge offs to be manageable by banks and other lenders; and 6) struggling commercial real estate office, which is typically just 1%-4% of loans for most banks.

Headwinds include 1) tighter lending standards; 2) rising household debt; 3) weak consumer

confidence/sentiment; 4) higher capital requirements for banks; and 5) “higher for longer” stance by the Federal Reserve.

According to S&P Capital IQ consensus estimates, sector EPS declined 15.6% in 2022 versus the 4.6% gain for the S&P 500, while sector revenues increased 4.5% versus the 12.1% gain recorded by the market on the whole. Sector EPS are projected to decline 3.2% in 2023 versus the 0.1% decline seen for the S&P 500, while sector revenues are forecast to fall by 12.1% versus the 1.1% anticipated gain for the market. For 2024, sector EPS should rise 6.3% compared to the S&P 500’s 11.7% increase, with sector revenues gaining 4.5% compared with the market’s gain of 5.2%. The sector’s price-to-earnings (P/E) ratio is 13.5x, based on consensus next-12-month operating EPS estimates, versus the S&P 500’s forward P/E of 18.8x. S&P Capital IQ also reports that the consensus long-term EPS growth estimate for this sector is 10.7% versus the S&P 500’s 12.7%, giving the sector a P/E-to-projected EPS growth rate (PEG) ratio of 1.3x, as compared with the broader market’s PEG of 1.5x. This sector pays a dividend yield of 2.0%, versus the yield of 1.7% for the S&P 500.

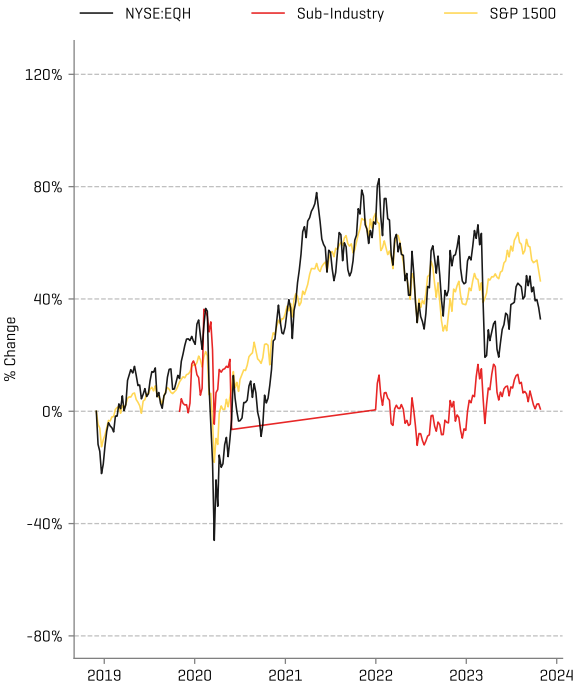
Finally, the technical outlook for this sector index is negative, based on its trailing 40-week (200-day) relative strength.

/ Sam Stovall

Industry Performance

GICS Sector: Financials
Sub-Industry: Diversified Financial Services

Based on S&P 1500 Indexes
Five-Year market price performance through Oct 28, 2023



NOTE: A sector chart appears when the sub-industry does not have sufficient historical index data.
All Sector & Sub-Industry information is based on the Global Industry Classification Standard [GICS].
Past performance is not an indication of future performance and should not be relied upon as such.
Source: CFRA, S&P Global Market Intelligence

Sub-Industry: Diversified Financial Services Peer Group*: Diversified Financial Services												
Peer Group	Stock Symbol	Exchange	Currency	Recent Stock Price	Stk. Mkt. Cap. [M]	30-Day Price Chg. [%]	1-Year Price Chg. [%]	P/E Ratio	Fair Value Calc.	Yield [%]	Return on Equity [%]	LTD to Cap [%]
Equitable Holdings, Inc.	EQH	NYSE	USD	26.69	9,271.0	-3.0	-9.4	6.0	23.18	3.3	23.1	47.7
AGBA Group Holding Limited	AGBA	NasdaqCM	USD	0.44	30.0	-30.6	-96.2	NM	N/A	N/A	-323.8	N/A
Alerus Financial Corporation	ALRS	NasdaqCM	USD	17.76	352.0	-0.6	-19.9	10.0	N/A	4.3	10.8	N/A
Apollo Global Management, Inc.	APO	NYSE	USD	81.02	45,930.0	-9.9	49.6	14.0	53.31	2.1	9.5	23.1
Corebridge Financial, Inc.	CRBG	NYSE	USD	20.21	12,853.0	2.9	-10.1	5.0	N/A	4.6	21.5	44.8
Jackson Financial Inc.	JXN	NYSE	USD	38.29	3,136.0	1.1	5.7	NM	N/A	6.5	-0.6	25.2
NewtekOne, Inc.	NEWT	NasdaqGM	USD	14.41	356.0	2.6	-9.5	13.0	N/A	5.0	9.0	75.3
Voya Financial, Inc.	VOYA	NYSE	USD	66.53	7,038.0	0.1	0.7	12.0	N/A	2.4	9.2	26.3

*For Peer Groups with more than 10 companies or stocks, selection of issues is based on market capitalization.
NA-Not Available; NM-Not Meaningful.
Note: Peers are selected based on Global Industry Classification Standards and market capitalization. The peer group list includes companies with similar characteristics, but may not include all the companies within the same industry and/or that engage in the same line of business.

Equitable Holdings, Inc.

Analyst Research Notes and other Company News

August 03, 2023

03:06 PM ET... CFRA Keeps Buy Opinion on Shares of Equitable Holdings, Inc. [EQH 28.60****]:

We lift our 12-month target by \$1 to \$33, valuing EQH shares at 4.7x our newly initiated 2025 operating EPS estimate of \$7.05 and at 5.2x our 2024 EPS estimate of \$6.40 [trimmed today by \$0.10], vs. its one-year average forward multiple of 5x and a peer average of 7.8x. We lower our 2023 EPS estimate by \$0.30 to \$4.95 after Q2 EPS of \$1.17 vs. \$1.23 lagged our \$1.32 EPS estimate and the \$1.24 consensus forecast, but included \$1.03 non-recurring tax charge. Operating revenues rose 9.3% on 18% higher premiums, 46% higher investment income, and 4% lower fee revenues. Individual Retirement group led results, with 26% higher operating profits, while Group Retirement profits were down 3.6% and Asset Management fell 2%. We raise our operating revenue forecast to an increase of 6%-9% in 2023 and 7%-10% in 2024. Currently trading at discount to peer and historical averages, with solid organic growth prospects and a strengthening balance sheet, we view the shares [currently yielding 3.1%] as undervalued. / Catherine Seifert

July 07, 2023

10:52 AM ET... CFRA Keeps Buy Opinion on Shares of Equitable Holdings, Inc. [EQH 27.21****]:

We lift our 12-month target price by \$6 to \$32, valuing EQH shares at 6.1x our 2023 operating EPS estimate of \$5.25 and at 4.9x our 2024 operating EPS estimate of \$6.50, versus the shares' three-year average forward multiple of 5x and a peer group average of 7x. After a 9.3% drop in operating revenues in 2022, we expect revenues to rise by 3%-5% in 2023. We also believe steps EQH has taken to reduce its risk profile [including reinsuring a large block of legacy annuities], coupled with management's commitment to grow operating profits by more than 10% annually through organic earnings generation, margin expansion, and capital management, will provide the shares with a catalyst. Our view is tempered by the concentration risk EQH has in variable annuities, though contributions from asset management [via its 65% control of AllianceBernstein] and other insurance and retirement products are offsets. Currently trading at 4.2x our 2024 operating EPS estimate and yielding 3.2%, we view EQH as undervalued versus peers. / Catherine Seifert

May 04, 2023

03:59 PM ET... CFRA Keeps Buy Opinion on Shares of Equitable Holdings, Inc. [EQH 22.89****]:

We cut our 12-month target by \$10, to \$26, valuing EQH shares at 4x our 2024 operating EPS estimate of \$6.50 [lowered today by \$0.30], versus a three-year average forward multiple of 5.1x and a peer average of 7.2x. We cut our 2023 EPS estimate by \$0.65, to \$5.25, after Q1 EPs of \$0.96 versus \$1.24 lagged our \$1.38 EPS estimate and the \$1.19 consensus forecast, as a fractional drop in operating revenues on decent fund flow trends was offset by a 48% rise in interest credited to policyholder accounts, which partly offset a 9% drop in benefit costs. There are a lot of puts and takes to these results, but we note several encouraging trends, like the \$3.2B of Q1 core inflows, including \$932M into EQH's individual retirement segment amid strong demand for registered index-linked annuities. We acknowledge that near-term market and interest rate volatility removes a near-term catalyst from the shares, but at current levels, we view EQH shares [yielding 3.9%] as undervalued versus peer and historical averages. / Catherine Seifert

February 10, 2023

12:16 AM ET... CFRA Keeps Buy Opinion on Shares of Equitable Holdings, Inc. [EQH 31.82****]:

We raise our 12-month target price by \$4 to \$36, valuing EQH shares at 5.3x our newly initiated 2024 operating EPS estimate of \$6.80 and at 6.1x our 2023 operating EPS estimate of \$5.90 [cut today by \$0.30], versus the shares' 5-year average forward multiple of 5.1x and a peer average of 8.4x. EQH posted Q4 operating EPS of \$1.11 versus \$1.54, below our \$1.35 EPS estimate and the \$1.25 consensus view, on 10% lower operating revenues as 8% higher premiums and 3% higher investment income was offset by 105 lower fee revenues and a 23% drop in asset management revenue. 2022 EPS of \$5.08 [versus \$6.58] also lagged our \$5.30 EPS estimate, the \$5.22 consensus view on 9.3% lower revenues. We see 3% to 5% higher operating revenues in 2023 and a 4% to 6% rise in 2024 on a modest recovery in asset values, and wider spreads on higher interest rates. Currently trading at 5.4x or 2023 operating EPS estimate and yielding 2.55, we view the shares as undervalued versus peers. / Catherine Seifert

November 04, 2022

12:17 AM ET... CFRA Keeps Buy Opinion on Shares of Equitable Holdings, Inc. [EQH 28.40****]:

We trim our 12-month target price by \$1 to \$32, valuing EQH shares at 5.2x our '23 operating EPS estimate of \$6.20 [lowered today by \$0.40], in line with its three-year average forward multiple, but below the peer group average of 9.8x. We lower our '22 operating EPS estimate by \$0.30 to \$5.30 after EQH posted Q3 operating EPS of \$1.28 versus \$1.94, below our \$1.45 EPS estimate, but above the \$1.10 consensus forecast, on 3.2% lower operating revenues, as 13% higher premiums were offset primarily by 11% lower asset management fees and 16% lower investment income. Total costs were down 3.5%, and most notably, benefit costs fell 17%. We also note EQH's actuarial review resulted in a \$23M positive impact, unlike some peers who took billion-dollar write-downs. Though a mixed near-term revenue growth outlook tempers our view, we view the shares, currently trading at 4.6x our '23 operating EPS estimate and yielding 2.8%, as undervalued versus peer historical averages. / Catherine Seifert

August 04, 2022

06:33 PM ET... CFRA Keeps Buy Opinion on Shares of Equitable Holdings, Inc. [EQH 28.51****]:

We keep our 12-month target price of \$33, valuing EQH shares at 5x our 2023 operating EPS estimate of \$6.60 [cut by \$0.70], in line with the shares' three-year average forward multiple of 5x, but below the peer group average of 9x, given EQH's above-peer market and interest rate sensitivity. We also lower our 2022 operating EPS estimate by \$0.70 to \$5.60 after EQH posted Q2 operating EPS of \$1.31 versus \$1.71, shy of our \$1.56 EPS estimate, but besting the \$1.26 consensus forecast. GAAP EPS of \$4.47 versus \$0.23 reflected hedging gains [excluded from EPS estimates]. We lower our 2022 operating revenue forecast to 1%-4% from 3%-6%, after market driven declines in fee revenues drove a 15% drop in Q2 operating revenues. We see operating revenues rising by 4%-7% in 2023. We view the shares as undervalued versus historical averages and see favorable inflow trends in many segments, like the \$634M Individual Retirement Q2 inflows, providing the shares [currently yielding 2.8%] with a catalyst. / Catherine Seifert

May 09, 2022

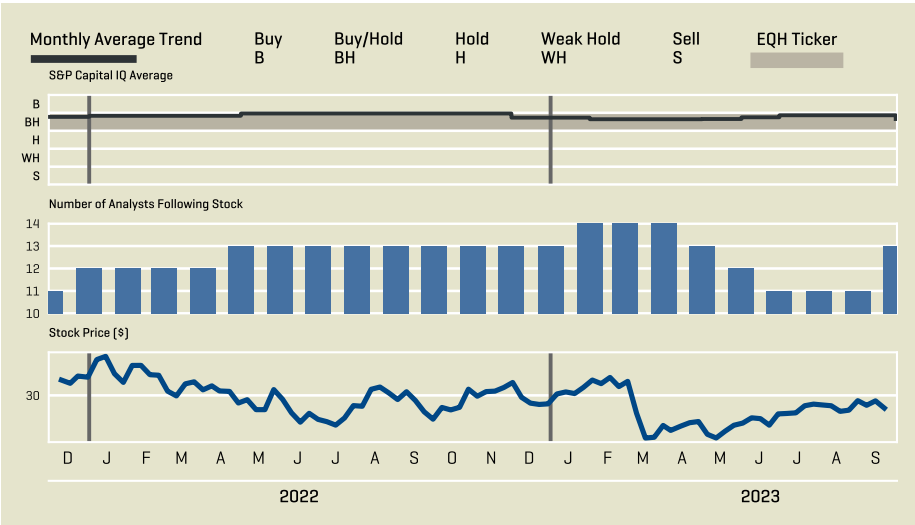
06:38 PM ET... CFRA Keeps Buy Opinion on Shares of Equitable Holdings, Inc. [EQH 28.32****]:

We cut our 12-month target price by \$9 to \$33, or 4.5x our 2023 operating EPS estimate of \$7.30 [cut today by \$0.10] and 5.2x our 2022 operating EPS estimate of \$6.30 [cut today by \$0.25] versus EQH's one-year average forward multiple of 5.3x and a peer average of 9.2x. Q1 operating EPS of \$1.36 versus \$1.35 lagged our \$1.57 operating EPS estimate and the \$1.51 consensus forecast, largely due to a \$0.17 actuarial charge. That aside, operating revenues declined fractionally, as strength in asset management, where \$12B of Q1 inflows drove a 4% year-to-year rise in assets under management [to \$856B] and propelled Q1 revenues up 7.8%, was offset by weakness in insurance and annuity lines, exacerbated by margin pressures amid 13% higher benefit costs. We see results improving sequentially, though we trim our 2022 revenue growth forecast to 3% to 6%, and see growth of 4% to 7% in 2023. At current levels, the shares' valuation does not adequately reflect the value of EQH's asset management franchise, in our view. / Catherine Seifert

Note: Research notes reflect CFRA's published opinions and analysis on the stock at the time the note was published. The note reflects the views of the equity analyst as of the date and time indicated in the note, and may not reflect CFRA's current view on the company.

Equitable Holdings, Inc.

Analysts Recommendations



	No. of Recommendations	% of Total	1 Mo. Prior	3 Mos. Prior
Buy	5	38	5	5
Buy/Hold	5	38	5	5
Hold	3	23	1	1
Weak hold	0	0	0	0
Sell	0	0	0	0
No Opinion	0	0	0	0
Total	13	100	11	11

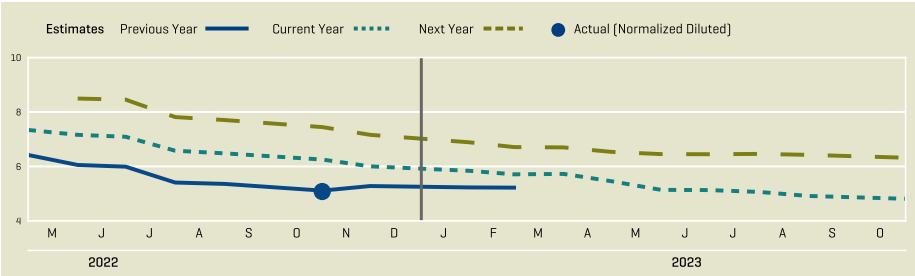
Wall Street Consensus Opinion

Buy/Hold

Wall Street Consensus vs. Performance

For fiscal year 2023, analysts estimate that EQH will earn USD 4.81. For fiscal year 2024, analysts estimate that EQH's earnings per share will grow by 31.47% to USD 6.32.

Wall Street Consensus Estimates



Fiscal Year	Avg Est.	High Est.	Low Est.	# of Est.	Est. P/E
2024	6.32	6.87	5.95	12	4.22
2023	4.81	4.96	4.64	11	5.55
2024 vs. 2023	▲ 31%	▲ 39%	▲ 28%	▲ 9%	▼ -24%
Q3'24	1.63	1.75	1.54	9	16.35
Q3'23	1.32	1.41	1.23	12	20.19
Q3'24 vs. Q3'23	▲ 23%	▲ 24%	▲ 25%	▼ -25%	▼ -19%

Forecasts are not reliable indicator of future performance.
Note: A company's earnings outlook plays a major part in any investment decision. S&P Global Market Intelligence organizes the earnings estimates of over 2,300 Wall Street analysts, and provides their consensus of earnings over the next two years, as well as how those earnings estimates have changed over time. Note that the information provided in relation to consensus estimates is not intended to predict actual results and should not be taken as a reliable indicator of future performance.
Note: For all tables, graphs and charts in this report that do not cite any reference or source, the source is S&P Global Market Intelligence.

Equitable Holdings, Inc.

Glossary

STARS

Since January 1, 1987, CFRA Equity and Fund Research Services, and its predecessor S&P Capital IQ Equity Research has ranked a universe of U.S. common stocks, ADRs [American Depositary Receipts], and ADSs [American Depositary Shares] based on a given equity's potential for future performance. Similarly, we have ranked Asian and European equities since June 30, 2002. Under proprietary STARS [Stock Appreciation Ranking System], equity analysts rank equities according to their individual forecast of an equity's future total return potential versus the expected total return of a relevant benchmark [e.g., a regional index (MSCI AC Asia Pacific Index, MSCI AC Europe Index or S&P 500® Index)], based on a 12-month time horizon. STARS was designed to help investors looking to put their investment decisions in perspective. Data used to assist in determining the STARS ranking may be the result of the analyst's own models as well as internal proprietary models resulting from dynamic data inputs.

S&P Global Market Intelligence's Quality Ranking

[also known as **S&P Capital IQ Earnings & Dividend Rankings**] - Growth and S&P Capital IQ Earnings & Dividend Rankings stability of earnings and dividends are deemed key elements in establishing S&P Global Market Intelligence's earnings and dividend rankings for common stocks, which are designed to capsize the nature of this record in a single symbol. It should be noted, however, that the process also takes into consideration certain adjustments and modifications deemed desirable in establishing such rankings. The final score for each stock is measured against a scoring matrix determined by analysis of the scores of a large and representative sample of stocks. The range of scores in the array of this sample has been aligned with the following ladder of rankings:

A+ Highest	B Below Average
A High	B- Lower
A Above	C Lowest
B+ Average	D In Reorganization
NC Not Ranked	

EPS Estimates

CFRA's earnings per share (EPS) estimates reflect analyst projections of future EPS from continuing operations, and generally exclude various items that are viewed as special, non-recurring, or extraordinary. Also, EPS estimates reflect either forecasts of equity analysts; or, the consensus [average] EPS estimate, which are independently compiled by S&P Global Market Intelligence, a data provider to CFRA. Among the items typically excluded from EPS estimates are asset sale gains; impairment, restructuring or merger-related charges; legal and insurance settlements; in process research and development expenses; gains or losses on the extinguishment of debt; the cumulative effect of accounting changes; and earnings related to operations that have been classified by the company as discontinued. The inclusion of some items, such as stock option expense and recurring types of other charges, may vary, and depend on such factors as industry practice, analyst judgment, and the extent to which some types of data is disclosed by companies.

12-Month Target Price

The equity analyst's projection of the market price a given security will command 12 months hence, based on a combination of intrinsic, relative, and private market valuation metrics, including Fair Value.

Abbreviations Used in Equity Research Reports

- CAGR - Compound Annual Growth Rate
- CAPEX - Capital Expenditures
- CY - Calendar Year
- DCF - Discounted Cash Flow
- DDM - Dividend Discount Model
- EBIT - Earnings Before Interest and Taxes
- EBITDA - Earnings Before Interest, Taxes, Depreciation & Amortization
- EPS - Earnings Per Share
- EV - Enterprise Value
- FCF - Free Cash Flow
- FFO - Funds From Operations
- FY - Fiscal Year
- P/E - Price/Earnings
- P/NAV - Price to Net Asset Value
- PEG Ratio - P/E-to-Growth Ratio
- PV - Present Value
- R&D - Research & Development
- ROCE - Return on Capital Employed
- ROE Return on Equity
- ROI - Return on Investment
- ROIC - Return on Invested Capital
- ROA - Return on Assets
- SG&A - Selling, General & Administrative Expenses
- SOTP - Sum-of-The-Parts
- WACC - Weighted Average Cost of Capital

Dividends on American Depositary Receipts (ADRs) and American Depositary Shares (ADSs) are net of taxes (paid in the country of origin).

Qualitative Risk Assessment

Reflects an equity analyst's view of a given company's operational risk, or the risk of a firm's ability to continue as an ongoing concern. The Qualitative Risk Assessment is a relative ranking to the U.S. STARS universe, and should be reflective of risk factors related to a company's operations, as opposed to risk and volatility measures associated with share prices. For an ETF this reflects on a capitalization-weighted basis, the average qualitative risk assessment assigned to holdings of the fund.

STARS Ranking system and definition:

★★★★★ 5-STARS (Strong Buy):

Total return is expected to outperform the total return of a relevant benchmark, by a notable margin over the coming 12 months, with shares rising in price on an absolute basis.

★★★★★ 4-STARS (Buy):

Total return is expected to outperform the total return of a relevant benchmark over the coming 12 months.

★★★★★ 3-STARS (Hold):

Total return is expected to closely approximate the total return of a relevant benchmark over the coming 12 months.

★★★★★ 2-STARS (Sell):

Total return is expected to underperform the total return of a relevant benchmark over the coming 12 months.

★★★★★ 1-STAR (Strong Sell):

Total return is expected to underperform the total return of a relevant benchmark by a notable margin over the coming 12 months, with shares falling in price on an absolute basis.

Relevant benchmarks:

In North America, the relevant benchmark is the S&P 500 Index, in Europe and in Asia, the relevant benchmarks are the MSCI AC Europe Index and the MSCI AC Asia Pacific Index, respectively.



Equitable Holdings, Inc.

Disclosures

Stocks are ranked in accordance with the following ranking methodologies:

STARS Stock Reports:

Qualitative STARS rankings are determined and assigned by equity analysts. For reports containing STARS rankings refer to the Glossary section of the report for detailed methodology and the definition of STARS rankings.

Quantitative Stock Reports:

Quantitative rankings are determined by ranking a universe of common stocks based on 5 measures or model categories: Valuation, Quality, Growth, Street Sentiment, and Price Momentum. In the U.S., a sixth sub-category for Financial Health will also be displayed. Percentile scores are used to compare each company to all other companies in the same universe for each model category. The five [six] model category scores are then weighted and rolled up into a single percentile ranking for that company. For reports containing quantitative rankings refer to the Glossary section seof the report for detailed methodology and the definition of Quantitative rankings.

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STARS Stock Reports:

Global STARS Distribution as of September 30, 2023

Ranking	North America	Europe	Asia	Global
Buy	36.8%	34.5%	41.6%	37.4%
Hold	53.8%	51.2%	50.3%	52.6%
Sell	9.4%	14.3%	8.1%	10.1%
Total	100.0%	100.0%	100.0%	100.0%

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